

Share Google Contacts

How to share contact groups with other people — and how to receive them — explained in plain language, one screen at a time.

The Sharing app is a website with two sides. If you *share* your contacts with others, you are the **Owner**. If someone shares contacts *with you*, you are a **Recipient**. This manual covers both. Read the chapters for your role, or all of them if you'll do both. Throughout, **button names** appear in color and figures show you where things are.

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Introduction: the two roles

Everything in the Sharing app happens in your web browser — there's nothing to install. You open a web address, sign in with Google, and the app shows you either your own groups (as an Owner) or the groups others have shared with you (as a Recipient).

The **Owner** picks one of their Google contact groups, chooses who should receive it, and sends the contacts over. The **Recipient** opens an invite link, connects their Google account, and the shared contacts appear in their own Google Contacts. Updates the Owner makes later can flow to recipients automatically.

TIP: SIGNING IN IS AUTOMATIC

There is no "Sign in" button to hunt for. When you open the app, it sends you straight to Google to sign in, then brings you back. The app's name shows simply as **Contacts** in the top bar.

Across the top of every page is a slim bar showing the app name, your signed-in Google email, and a **Refresh** link to reload. Recipients also get a **Switch account** link there, for when they need to sign in as a different person. At the very bottom, an **App Information** note explains that the app uses your Google Contacts only as needed for sharing and importing.

CHAPTER TWO

Owner: getting started

To begin as an Owner, open the app's main web address in your browser and sign in with Google when prompted. The address is:

```
https://share-contacts-7frzetx7sa-uc.a.run.app/
```

(If you run your own Share server, use your own address instead — it ends in `.run.app/`.)

TIP: OPEN IT STRAIGHT FROM CONTACTSFREESHARE

You don't have to remember the address. In the ContactsFreeShare desktop app, the **Share Contacts** menu item opens this same Sharing app in a new browser tab. (It appears once you're connected to Google and signed in as the Editor.)

Once you're signed in, you land on the **Your groups** screen.

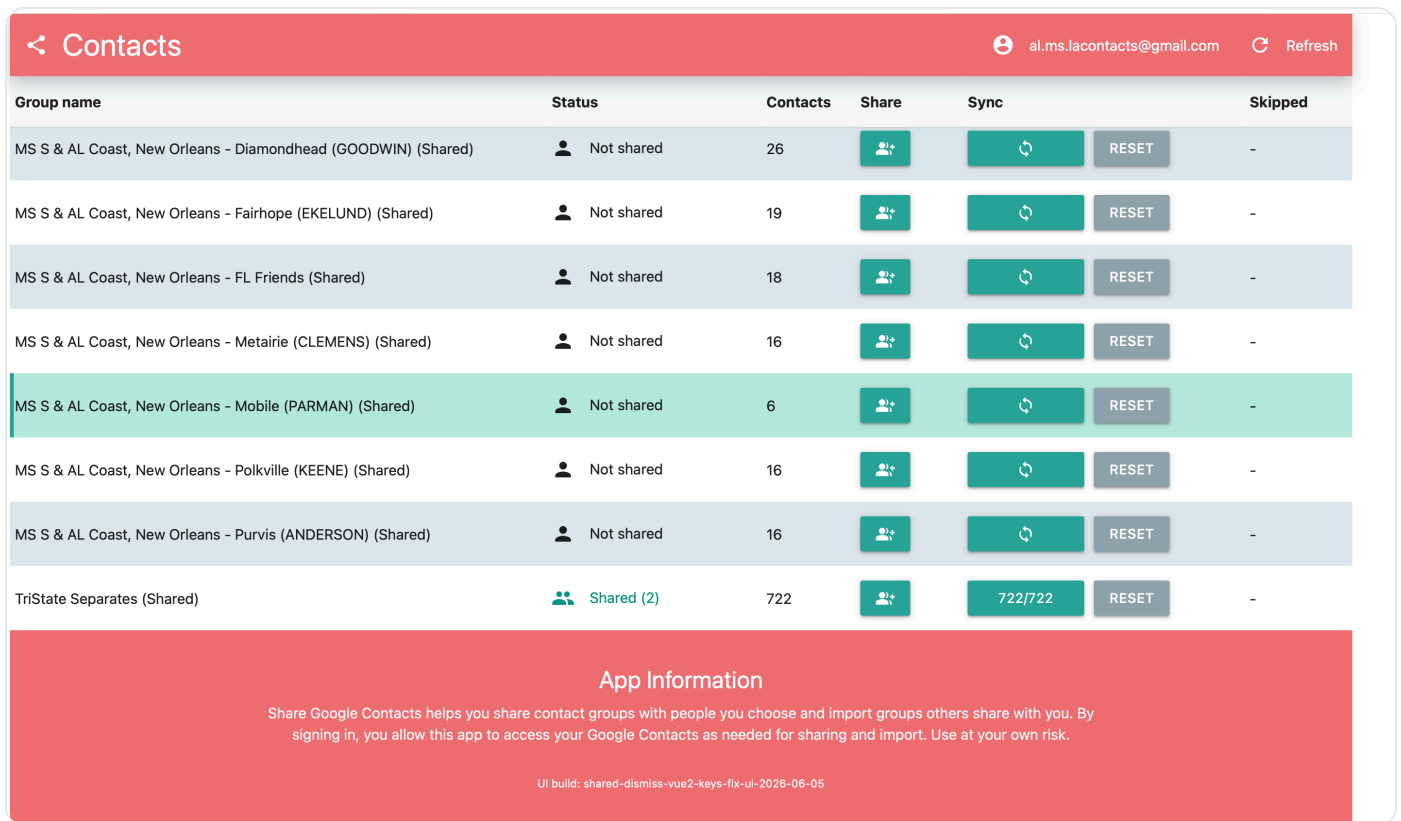


Figure 1. The owner's "Your groups" screen.

This table lists your Google contact groups (labels). For each one you'll see:

Column	What it shows
Group name	The name of the Google contact group.
Status	Shared (N) when it's shared with N people, or Not shared .
Contacts	How many people are in the group.
Share	A button that opens the sharing window.
Sync	The button that sends contacts to recipients, plus a Reset button.
Skipped	A number if any contacts were skipped, otherwise a dash.

CHAPTER THREE

Owner: sharing a group

Sharing happens in two steps: first you *share* a group with the people you choose, and then you *sync* to actually send the contacts (Chapter Four). Start by clicking the **Share** button on the group's row. A window titled **Share with people** opens.

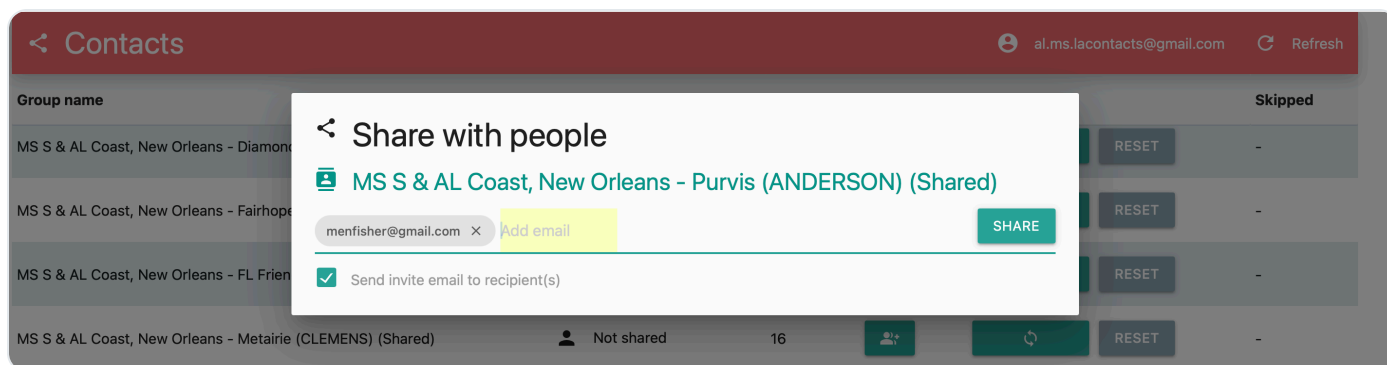


Figure 2. The "Share with people" window.

Type a recipient's email address into the **Add email** box and press Enter; it becomes a small chip. Add as many as you like. The **Send invite email to recipient(s)** checkbox is ticked by default. When you're ready, click **Share** (it briefly reads **Sharing...**). Anyone you've already shared with appears in a **Collaborators** list inside the same window.

Getting the invite link to your recipients

On a server you host yourself, the app does not send the email for you. Instead, when you click Share with the invite box ticked, your computer's email program opens a ready-made draft (subject **Share Google Contacts**) containing the invite link — you just press Send. If you prefer, untick the box and send the link yourself. The link always looks like this, with the recipient's address on the end:

```
https://your-share-app-address/?mode=shared&email=recipient@example.com
```

TIP: SHARING IS NOT SENDING YET

Adding a recipient only puts them on the list. The contacts don't move until you click **Sync**. After you share, the app reminds you with a message like "... was shared. Click *Sync* to push contacts to recipients."

Contacts

al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com Refresh

Your groups

Shared with 1 recipient(s). Prepared 5/5 contact(s). Email notification skipped — send the invite link manually.
"AL Central - Marbury (Van HOUTEN) (Shared)" was shared. Click Sync to push contacts to recipients.

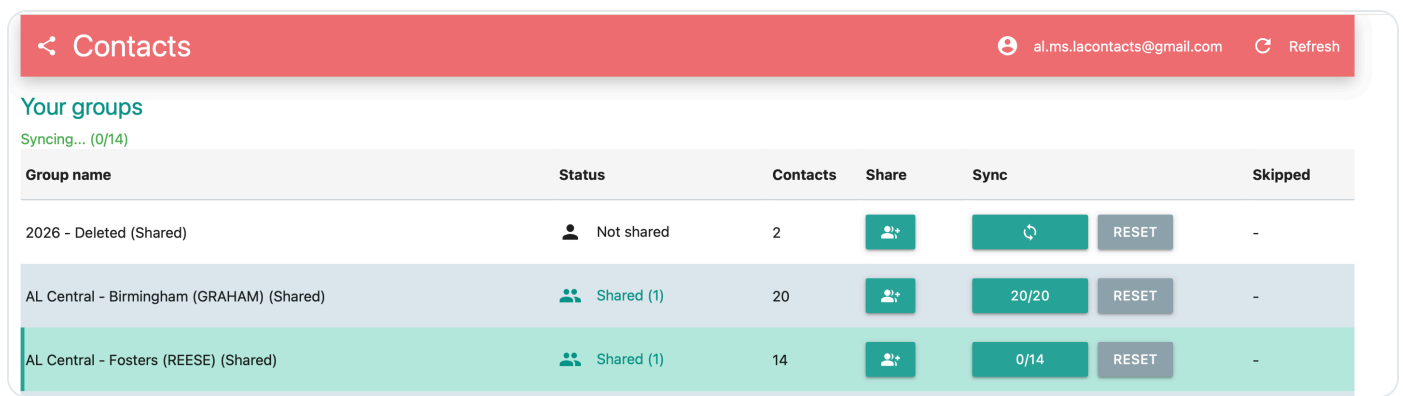
Group name	Status	Contacts	Share	Sync		Skipped
2026 - Deleted (Shared)	Not shared	2			RESET	-
AL Central - Birmingham (GRAHAM) (Shared)	Not shared	20			RESET	-
AL Central - Fosters (REESE) (Shared)	Not shared	14			RESET	-
AL Central - Marbury (Van HOUTEN) (Shared)	Shared (1)	5			RESET	-

Figure 3. The confirmation and reminder shown after sharing.

CHAPTER FOUR

Owner: syncing contacts to recipients

Once a group has at least one recipient, click the **Sync** button on its row to send the contacts. The app prepares your contacts and delivers them to each recipient in the background. While it works, the button shows a running count such as **5/25**, and a green line above the table reports progress like *"Syncing... (5/25)."*



The screenshot shows a mobile app interface titled 'Contacts'. At the top, there's a red header bar with a back arrow, the title 'Contacts', a user profile icon, the email 'al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com', and a 'Refresh' button. Below the header, it says 'Your groups' and 'Syncing... (0/14)'. The main content is a table with columns: Group name, Status, Contacts, Share, Sync, and Skipped. There are three rows of groups, each with a different background color (light blue, light green, and light blue). The first row is '2026 - Deleted (Shared)' with status 'Not shared', 2 contacts, a share button, a sync button showing a circular arrow, a 'RESET' button, and 0 skipped contacts. The second row is 'AL Central - Birmingham (GRAHAM) (Shared)' with status 'Shared (1)', 20 contacts, a share button, a sync button showing '20/20', a 'RESET' button, and 0 skipped contacts. The third row is 'AL Central - Fosters (REESE) (Shared)' with status 'Shared (1)', 14 contacts, a share button, a sync button showing '0/14', a 'RESET' button, and 0 skipped contacts.

Group name	Status	Contacts	Share	Sync	Skipped
2026 - Deleted (Shared)	Not shared	2			RESET -
AL Central - Birmingham (GRAHAM) (Shared)	Shared (1)	20		20/20	RESET -
AL Central - Fosters (REESE) (Shared)	Shared (1)	14		0/14	RESET -

Figure 4. Syncing contacts to recipients.

You can sync again any time you change the group — re-syncing updates the shared copy for everyone. If a recipient hasn't connected their account yet, you'll see a note such as *"Ready — waiting for recipient to connect,"* which simply means their contacts are staged and will land as soon as they connect (Chapter Seven).

Reset and skipped contacts

The grey **Reset** button beside Sync clears the sync state for that group (it does *not* delete anyone's contacts) and asks you to confirm first. If the **Skipped** column shows a number, click it to open a **Skipped Contacts** list explaining which entries couldn't be sent and why.

Owner: managing the people you share with

To change who receives a group, open its **Share with people** window again. Everyone currently on the list appears under **Collaborators**. To stop sharing with someone, click the **Remove** button next to their email; the app confirms with *"Removed ...from this group."* When you remove the last person, the group's status returns to **Not shared**.

TIP: REMOVING DOESN'T DELETE THEIR CONTACTS

Taking someone off the list stops future updates, but it does not reach into their Google account to delete contacts they already received.

Recipient: getting started

If someone has shared contacts with you, you'll receive an invite link. Open it in your web browser. It looks like this, usually with your email address on the end:

```
https://their-share-app-address/?mode=shared&email=you@example.com
```

When you open the link, the app sends you to Google to sign in. **Sign in with the same Google account the invite was sent to** — this is the most common point of confusion. After signing in, you land on the **Groups shared with you** screen.

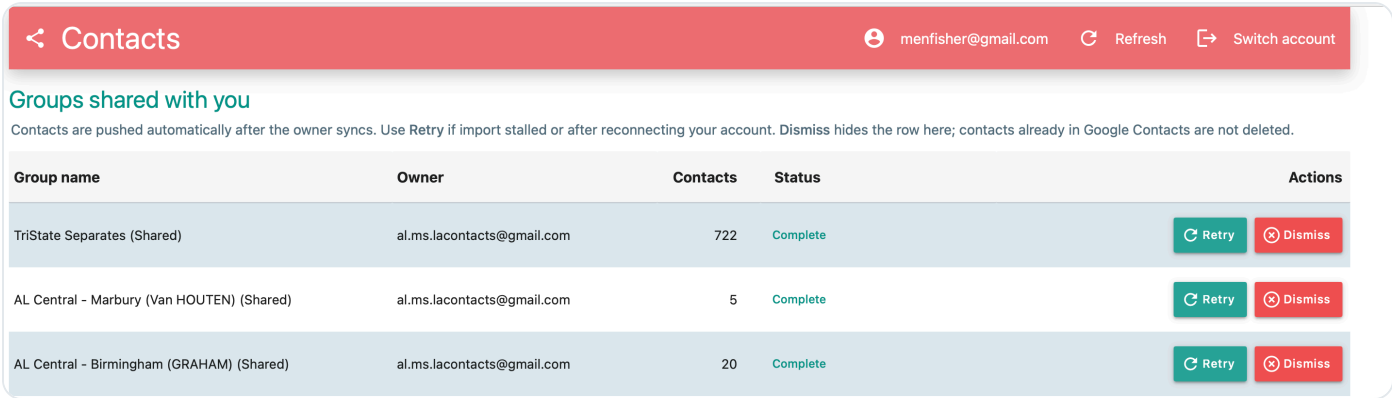


Figure 5. The recipient's "Groups shared with you" screen.

The table lists each shared group, who it's from, how many contacts it holds, its current status, and two action buttons: **Retry** and **Dismiss** (covered in the next chapters).

HEADS-UP: SIGNED IN AS THE WRONG PERSON?

If you signed in with a different account than the invite, the app shows a red notice like "This invite is for ... but you are signed in as ...," with a **Switch account** link. Click it, sign in with the correct account, and open the invite link again.

Wrong Google account

This invite is for menfisher@gmail.com, but you signed in as al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com.

Use Switch account below, then open the invite link from your email again.

[Try sign-in again](#)

Figure 6. The wrong-account warning.

Recipient: connecting your Google account

Before contacts can be added to your address book, you give the app permission to write to your Google Contacts. If a yellow banner appears reading **Connect your Google account**, click the **Connect account** button and approve access on the Google screen that follows. When you return, you'll see *"Account connected,"* and the import usually starts on its own.

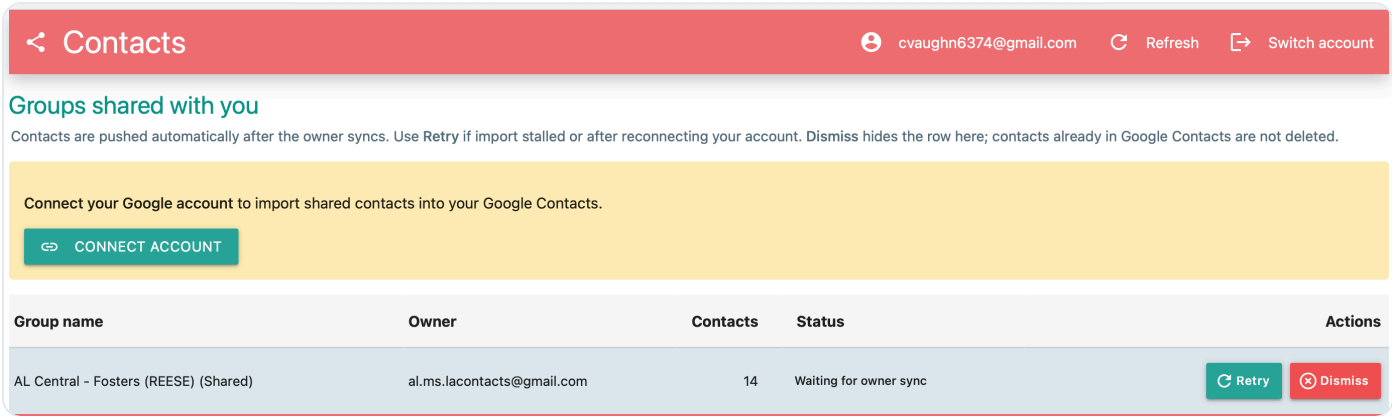


Figure 7. Connecting your Google account.

If you connected a while ago and permission has lapsed, you may instead see a red **Reconnect your Google account** banner; click **Reconnect account** and approve again. This is normal and just refreshes the permission.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Recipient: importing the shared contacts

Once you're connected, the app adds the shared contacts to your Google account automatically. The **Status** column tells you where things stand and shows a progress bar with a running count such as **5/25**.

AL Central - Birmingham (GRAHAM) (Shared)	al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com	20	Adding photos Contacts imported	0/20 photos	Retry Dismiss
AL Central - Fosters (REESE) (Shared)	al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com	14	Pushing contacts	0/14	Retry Dismiss

Figure 8. Contacts importing.

You may see the status move through a few stages — *Waiting for owner sync*, *Importing contacts* or *Pushing contacts*, then *Adding photos* — and finally **Complete** in teal when everything has arrived. At that point the contacts are in your Google Contacts, usually in a group whose name ends with *(shared)*.

AL Central - Birmingham (GRAHAM) (Shared)	al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com	20	Complete	Retry Dismiss
AL Central - Fosters (REESE) (Shared)	al.ms.lacontacts@gmail.com	14	Complete	Retry Dismiss

Figure 9. A finished import.

If progress seems stuck, or you've just reconnected your account, click **Retry** on that group's row to nudge the import along. It's safe to press more than once.

Recipient: dismissing a shared group

If you no longer want a shared group cluttering your list, click **Dismiss** on its row. A window titled **Dismiss shared group** asks you to confirm. Dismissing only hides the row from this list — it *does not* delete the contacts already imported into your Google Contacts.

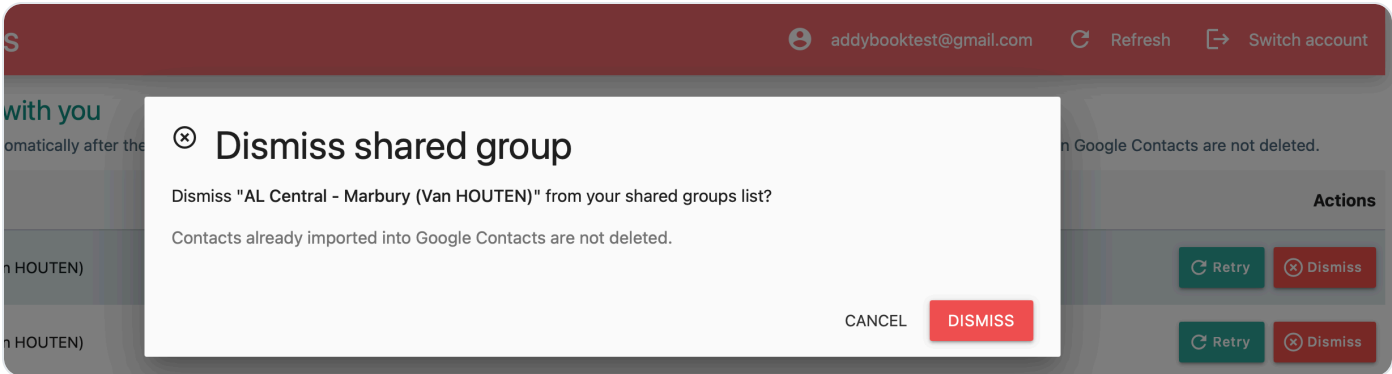


Figure 10. Dismissing a shared group.

Troubleshooting

Most snags are about signing in or which account you used.

If the page shows an error and a **Sign in again** link, click it — your session likely expired. If the app says you're *"viewing your own contact groups instead of shared invites,"* you opened the plain address instead of the invite link; reopen the link that ends in `?mode=shared`. If nothing is shared with you and you expected something, make sure you signed in with the exact account the invite was sent to — use **Switch account**, then open the invite again (an incognito or private browser window helps avoid signing in as the wrong person).

After Google sign-in, you might occasionally land on a plain page titled **Login failed, Wrong Google account**, or **Connect failed**. Each offers a **Try sign-in again** link; follow it and sign in carefully with the right account. And whenever the screen looks out of date, the **Refresh** link in the top bar reloads the latest status.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Status words, explained

Here's what the words in the **Status** column mean.

Status	Meaning
Not shared	(Owner) The group hasn't been shared with anyone yet.
Shared (N)	(Owner) The group is shared with N people.
Waiting for owner sync	(Recipient) The owner shared the group but hasn't pressed Sync yet.
Connect account to import	(Recipient) You need to connect your Google account first.
Ready to import / Queued	Contacts are staged and lined up to be added.
Importing / Pushing contacts	Contacts are being added to the account right now.
Adding photos	The contacts are in; their photos are being added.
Complete	Everything has arrived in Google Contacts.
Up to date	Nothing new to send; the shared copy already matches.

That's the whole Sharing app. Owners share and sync; recipients connect and import — and the app keeps the two in step.